QP: 25901881

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION April 2026

SECOND SEMESTER

SDC - MG2SDCTHM100 - FRONT OFFICE MANAGEMENT (2025 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Part A

One Word Answer Answer any 5 questions Each question carries 1 marks

1. Early details help faster (check-in / delay). [An] / [CO1]
   Answer: check-in
2. Proper record avoids (overbooking / gardening). [An] / [CO2]
   Answer: overbooking
3. Room assignment is part of (registration / cooking). [U] / [CO3]
   Answer: registration
4. Listening complaint helps understand (problem / music). [An] / [CO5]
   Answer: problem
5. Good welcome creates good (impression / complaint). [U] / [CO1]
   Answer: impression
6. Front Office connects hotel with (guests / machines). [U] / [CO1]
   Answer: guests
7. Clear policy avoids revenue (loss / increase always). [An] / [CO2]
   Answer: loss

Part B

Short Answer Question Answer any 5 questions Each question carries 2 marks

8. **Define medical emergency in a hotel context. [K] / [CO5]**
   Answer: A medical emergency in a hotel refers to a sudden illness, injury, or health condition of a guest or staff member requiring immediate medical attention.

9. **State the importance of positive body language in guest handling. [U] / [CO3]**
   Answer: Positive body language creates a friendly impression, improves communication, and helps guests feel comfortable and respected.

10. **State one example of cancellation charge. [A] / [CO2]**
    Answer: Charging one night room rent for cancelling a reservation at the last minute is an example of a cancellation charge.

11. **Explain automated front office system. [U] / [CO1]**
    Answer: An automated front office system is a computerized system used for reservations, check-in, check-out, billing, and guest record management in hotels.

12. **State the importance of checking room availability for walk-in guests. [An] / [CO2]**
    Answer: Checking room availability helps avoid overbooking and ensures proper room allocation for walk-in guests.

13. **State one benefit of proper settlement procedure. [E] / [CO4]**
    Answer: Proper settlement procedure ensures accurate billing and increases guest satisfaction during check-out.

14. **List any two functions of the Front Office department. [K] / [CO1]**
    Answer:

- Reservation handling
- Guest registration and check-in procedures

Part C

Essay Question Answer any 5 questions Each question carries 5 marks

15. Explain the importance of etiquettes in dealing with hotel guests. [An] / [CO1]

Etiquettes are the polite manners and professional behavior followed while interacting with guests in a hotel.

Importance of etiquettes:

- Creates a positive first impression
- Builds guest confidence and satisfaction
- Improves communication between staff and guests
- Helps maintain professionalism in hotel operations
- Encourages repeat visits and customer loyalty
- Enhances the reputation and image of the hotel

- Reduces misunderstandings and complaints

Conclusion:

Good etiquettes are essential in hospitality because they ensure respectful and pleasant guest experiences.

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16. Describe the role of front office cashier in hotel operations. [U] / [CO1]

The front office cashier handles guest accounts and financial transactions in the hotel.

Roles and responsibilities:

- Preparing guest bills and invoices
- Collecting payments through cash, card, or online methods
- Maintaining guest account records
- Handling currency exchange where applicable
- Posting charges for room service, food, and other services
- Verifying billing accuracy during check-out
- Coordinating with other departments regarding guest charges

Importance:

The front office cashier ensures smooth financial operations and accurate settlement of guest accounts.

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17. Discuss the objectives of reservation system in a hotel. [An] / [CO2]

A reservation system is used to manage room bookings efficiently in hotels.

Objectives of reservation system:

- To ensure advance booking of rooms
- To maintain proper room occupancy levels
- To avoid overbooking and underbooking
- To provide accurate room availability information
- To improve guest convenience and satisfaction
- To help in forecasting room sales and revenue
- To maintain proper guest reservation records

Conclusion:

An effective reservation system improves operational efficiency and increases hotel revenue.

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18. Evaluate the role of proper emergency handling in protecting hotel image. [E] / [CO5]

Emergency handling refers to the actions taken during situations such as fire, accidents, medical emergencies, or security threats.

Role in protecting hotel image:

- Ensures safety of guests and staff
- Reduces panic and confusion during emergencies
- Shows professionalism and preparedness of the hotel
- Builds guest trust and confidence
- Prevents negative publicity and reputation damage
- Helps hotels comply with safety regulations
- Improves customer satisfaction even during difficult situations

Conclusion:

Proper emergency handling is important for maintaining the safety, reputation, and credibility of a hotel.

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19. Describe the principles of handling guest complaints in a hotel. [U] / [CO5]

Guest complaints should be handled carefully and professionally to maintain guest satisfaction.

Principles of complaint handling:

- Listen carefully to the guest
- Remain calm and polite
- Show empathy and understanding
- Avoid arguments with guests
- Apologize sincerely for inconvenience
- Find quick and suitable solutions
- Follow up to ensure guest satisfaction
- Record complaints for future improvement

Conclusion:

Effective complaint handling helps improve guest relations and strengthens the hotel's reputation.

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20. Analyse the role of reservation system in controlling room inventory. [An] / [CO2]

Room inventory refers to the total number of rooms available for sale in a hotel.

Role of reservation system:

- Provides real-time room availability information
- Prevents overbooking and double booking
- Helps allocate rooms efficiently
- Tracks occupied, vacant, and reserved rooms
- Assists management in forecasting demand
- Supports better pricing and revenue management
- Improves coordination between departments

Conclusion:

A reservation system plays a vital role in managing room inventory efficiently and maximizing hotel occupancy.

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21. Evaluate the role of departure stage in creating a positive last impression. [E] / [CO1]

The departure stage is the final interaction between the guest and the hotel during check-out.

Role in creating positive impression:

- Ensures smooth and quick check-out process
- Provides accurate billing and settlement
- Allows staff to thank guests warmly
- Gives an opportunity to collect guest feedback
- Encourages repeat visits and recommendations
- Leaves guests with pleasant memories of the hotel
- Reflects the professionalism of hotel staff

Conclusion:

The departure stage is important because the final impression strongly influences guest satisfaction and future loyalty.

Part D

Long Essay Question, Answer any 2 questions, Each question carries 15 marks

22. Describe in detail the sources and methods of reservation used in modern hotels. [U] / [CO2]

Reservation is the process of booking rooms in advance for guests. Modern hotels use different sources and methods to receive reservations efficiently.

Sources of Reservation

1. Direct Reservation

Reservations made directly with the hotel by guests through:

- Telephone
- Email
- Hotel website
- Walk-in booking

2. Travel Agencies

Travel agencies book rooms on behalf of travelers and tour groups.

3. Online Travel Agencies (OTAs)

Websites such as Booking.com and MakeMyTrip provide online hotel booking services.

4. Corporate Reservations

Companies reserve rooms for business travelers and official meetings.

5. Central Reservation System (CRS)

A centralized booking network used by hotel chains to manage reservations across multiple properties.

6. Global Distribution System (GDS)

Computerized systems connecting hotels with airlines and travel agencies worldwide.

7. Tour Operators

Tour operators reserve rooms for package tours and group travelers.

Methods of Reservation

1. Telephone Reservation

Guests contact the hotel directly through phone calls.

2. Online Reservation

Bookings made through hotel websites or mobile applications.

3. Email Reservation

Guests send booking requests through email communication.

4. Mobile App Reservation

Hotels provide apps for easy booking and payment.

5. Walk-in Reservation

Guests reserve rooms by visiting the hotel directly.

6. Guaranteed Reservation

Rooms are held for guests until arrival because advance payment or credit card guarantee is provided.

7. Non-Guaranteed Reservation

Rooms are held only for a limited time without payment guarantee.

Importance of Reservation System

- Ensures room availability management
- Prevents overbooking
- Improves occupancy and revenue
- Enhances guest convenience
- Maintains accurate guest records

Conclusion

Modern reservation systems help hotels operate efficiently, improve customer service, and maximize room sales.

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23. Evaluate the legal and operational importance of maintaining registration records in hotels. [E] / [CO3]

Registration records are official documents containing guest details collected during check-in.

Legal Importance

1. Proof of Guest Stay

Registration records act as legal evidence of a guest's stay in the hotel.

2. Government Requirement

Hotels are required to maintain guest records according to tourism and police regulations.

3. Security and Safety

Records help authorities identify guests during emergencies or investigations.

4. Foreign Guest Documentation

Hotels must maintain passport and visa details of international guests.

5. Prevention of Illegal Activities

Proper records help prevent fraud, crime, and misuse of hotel facilities.

Operational Importance

1. Smooth Check-in and Check-out

Guest information helps provide faster services.

2. Room Management

Records help track room occupancy and availability.

3. Billing and Settlement

Accurate guest details support proper billing procedures.

4. Guest History Maintenance

Hotels can maintain guest preferences and improve future services.

5. Coordination Between Departments

Front office, housekeeping, and security departments use registration records for smooth operations.

6. Business Analysis

Hotels use records to analyze occupancy trends and customer behavior.

Conclusion

Maintaining registration records is essential for legal compliance, hotel security, efficient operations, and improved guest service.

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24. Explain in detail the procedures followed in handling guest inquiries and messages including telephone etiquette. [A] / [CO4]

Handling guest inquiries and messages is an important responsibility of the front office department.

Procedures for Handling Guest Inquiries

1. Greeting the Guest

Guests should be welcomed politely with a smile and respectful communication.

2. Listening Carefully

Staff should listen attentively to understand the guest's needs or questions.

3. Providing Accurate Information

Correct details regarding rooms, tariffs, facilities, and hotel services should be given.

4. Responding Promptly

Quick responses improve guest satisfaction.

5. Maintaining Professionalism

Staff should remain polite, patient, and helpful at all times.

6. Recording Special Requests

Guest requests and complaints should be properly noted and communicated to concerned departments.

Handling Guest Messages

Procedures:

- Receive messages accurately
- Record guest name, room number, date, and time
- Deliver messages promptly to guests
- Maintain confidentiality of guest information
- Confirm delivery of important messages

Telephone Etiquette in Hotels

Telephone etiquette refers to the professional manner of handling calls.

Important Rules:

- Answer calls promptly, usually within three rings
- Greet politely with hotel name and staff introduction
- Speak clearly and politely

- Use positive and professional language
- Avoid putting guests on hold for long periods
- Take messages accurately
- Thank the caller before ending the conversation

Importance:

- Creates positive impression of the hotel
- Improves communication and guest satisfaction
- Reflects professionalism of hotel staff

Conclusion

Proper handling of guest inquiries, messages, and telephone communication improves hotel service quality and strengthens guest relations.

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25. Explain in detail the concept of job description and the front office staffing process.

Job Description [U] / [CO1]

A job description is a written statement explaining the duties, responsibilities, qualifications, and working conditions of a particular job position.

Elements of Job Description

- Job title
- Duties and responsibilities
- Required qualifications and skills
- Reporting authority
- Working hours and conditions
- Salary and benefits

Importance of Job Description

- Clarifies employee responsibilities
- Helps in recruitment and training
- Improves work efficiency
- Reduces confusion among staff

- Assists performance evaluation

Front Office Staffing Process

Front office staffing refers to recruiting and managing employees for front office operations.

Steps in Staffing Process

1. Manpower Planning

Determining the number of employees required.

2. Recruitment

Attracting suitable candidates for front office jobs.

3. Selection

Choosing qualified candidates through interviews and tests.

4. Training and Orientation

Providing training regarding hotel procedures and guest handling.

5. Job Assignment

Assigning duties based on employee skills and experience.

6. Performance Evaluation

Assessing employee performance regularly.

7. Motivation and Development

Encouraging staff through incentives, promotions, and career development programs.

Front Office Positions

- Front Office Manager
- Receptionist
- Reservation Assistant
- Front Office Cashier
- Bell Desk Staff
- Telephone Operator

Importance of Proper Staffing

- Improves guest service quality
- Ensures smooth hotel operations
- Increases employee efficiency
- Enhances guest satisfaction
- Supports hotel reputation and profitability

Conclusion

Job descriptions and proper staffing are essential for efficient front office management and successful hotel operations.